

Static GK Test -22

Q1. At present, the Grand Trunk Road extends from _____ in India.

- (a) Kashmir to Kanyakumari
- (b) Amritsar to Kolkata**
- (c) Chennai to Kolkata
- (d) Agra to Kolkata

Solution: 6.(b) The Grand Trunk Road runs from Amritsar to Kolkata in India. This road was built by Sher Shah Suri in the 16th century. National Highway 1 is known as Sher Shah Suri Marg. Sher Shah Suri {(Farid Khan), founder of the Suri Empire in India, capital in Sasaram in modern-day Bihar}. Sher Shah issued a coin of silver which was termed the Rupiya .

Q2. 'Kalasam' is a dance sequence in which of the following classical dances of India?

- (a) Kathak
- (b) Kathakali**
- (c) Bharatanatyam
- (d) Manipuri

Solution: 8 . (b) Kathakali . It is a classical Indian dance form of Kerala. The text of Kathakali songs known as Attakkatha. Major instruments used in Kathakali music - Chenda, Maddalam, Chengila and Elathalam. Other Indian classical dances - Kathak (Uttar Pradesh) , Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu), Manipuri (Manipur), Odissi (Odisha), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Sattriya (Assam), Mohiniyattam (Kerala).

Q3. Which Indian writer wrote the famous book "Mansarovar"?

- (a) Gita Sahgal
- (b) Ram Prasad Bismil
- (c) Premchand**
- (d) Yashpal

Solution: 5.(c) Premchand. Mansarovar - Short stories of eight-volume series. Books of Mushi Premchand : Godaan, Idgah, Do Bailon Ki Katha, Kaphan, Nirmala, Gaban, Poos Ki Raat, Sevasadan, Namak Ka Daroga, Panch Parmeshwar etc. Books of Yashpal : Jhutha Sach, Meri Teri Uski Baat, Phulo Ka Kurta, Bhookh Ke Teen Din etc.

Q4. Indian classical violinist Annavarapu Rama Swamy was awarded with the _____ in 2021.

- (a) Padma Shri**
- (b) Sangeet Natak Akademi
- (c) Padma Vibhushan
- (d) Padma Bhushan

Solution: 9.(a) Padma Shri (2021). Dr. Annavarapu Ramaswamy, a renowned Indian classical violinist from Andhra Pradesh, is noted for his contributions to music, including the invention of new Ragas and Talas such as Vandana Raga, Sri Durga Raga, Tinetradi Tala, and Vedadi Tala.

Q5. Who is famo usly known as the father of the Indian nuclear programme?

- (a) Homi J. Bhabha**
- (b) Vikram Sarabhai
- (c) C.V.Raman
- (d) Venkatraman Radhakrishnan

Solution: 6.(a) Homi J. Bhabha . Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (Mumbai - 1954), Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (Mumbai - 1945), ISRO (Bangalore - 1969), DRDO (New Delhi - 1958). Vikram Sarabhai - Father of Indian Space Programme. APJ Abdul Kalam - Missile Man of India.

Q6. What is the primary objective of the 'Standup India' initiative?

- (a) To boost the manufacturing sector
- (b) To promote digital transactions nationwide
- (c) To facilitate bank loans for SC/ST and women entrepreneurs**
- (d) To support all types of startups

Solution: 7.(c) Stand-Up India, launched on April 5, 2016, promotes entrepreneurship among women and SC/ST communities. It offers bank loans from ₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore for setting up greenfield enterprises in manufacturing, trading, or services sectors. The initiative aims to foster economic growth and create jobs by supporting marginalized groups in business ventures.

Q7. Which player among the following is the twenty-third Woman Grandmaster of India?

- (a) Priyanka Nutakki**
- (b) Eesha Karavade
- (c) Bhakti Kulkarni
- (d) Subbaraman Vijayalakshmi

Solution: 5 . (a) Priyanka Nutakki. Bhakti kulkarni - She became Goa's first woman grandmaster after her name was cleared by the world chess federation. Subbaraman Vijayalakshmi - She is the first female Indian Grandmaster in chess (2001) and FIDE title of International Master. She was awarded the Arjuna Award (2001). Eesha Karavade (Chess Player from Pune) - Titles of International Master and Woman Grandmaster (2005).

Q8. Which of the following is celebrated as the "Tibetan New Year"?

- (a) Lohang
- (b) Losar**
- (c) Myoko
- (d) Murung

Solution: 14.(b) Losar , also known as Tibetan New Year, is a festival in Tibetan Buddhism. It is mainly celebrated in Tibet, Bhutan, Nepal (called Lhochhar), and India (Arunachal Pradesh, Sikkim, and Ladakh). Myoko festival and Murung festivals are celebrated by the Apatani Tribe of Ziro valley in Arunachal Pradesh.

Q9. Dhuska is the most popular food item of state of _____ .

- (a) Punjab
- (b) Jharkhand**
- (c) Kerala
- (d) Andhra Pradesh

Solution: 9.(b) Jharkhand . Other Foods of Jharkhand- Handia, Litti Chokha, Mirchi Ka Salan, Mitha Khaja, Rugra. Punjab : Sarso ka saag and Makki di Roti, Lassi, Gobhi - Shalgam- Gajar Pickle, Pinni. Kerala : Erissery, Sadya, Appam With Ishtu, Idli Sambar, Nadan Kozhi Varuthathu. Andhra Pradesh : Pulihora, Gutti vankaya kura, Chepa Pulusu, Gongura Pickle Ambadi, Pesarattu, Gutti Vankaya Koorra, Punugulu, Bobbatlu, Medu Vada, Uppindi.

Q10. Urmila Satyanarayanan is an exponent of which Indian classical dance form?

- (a) Bharatanatyam**
- (b) Kathak
- (c) Manipuri
- (d) Sattriya

Solution: 1.(a) Bharatanatyam . Urmila Satyanarayanan (Tamil nadu). Awards: Kalaimamani award (1997), Nritya Choodaman (2001). Other dancers: Bharatanatyam - Rukmini Devi Arundale, Padma Subrahmanyam, Mallika Sarabhai, Yamini Krishnamurthy. Kathak - Birju Maharaj, Shovana Narayan, Sitara Devi. Manipuri - Guru Bipin Singh, Darshana Jhaveri Nayana, Ranjana, Suverna. Sattriya - Krishnakshi Kashyap, Gorima Hazarika.

Q11. Under Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana, the maximum premium payable by the farmers will be _____ for all kharif food and oilseeds crops.

- (a) 4%
- (b) 2%**
- (c) 6%
- (d) 8%

Solution: 6.(b) 2%. The Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY), launched on 18 February 2016 by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, is an insurance service for farmers' crops. It follows the "One Nation–One Scheme" concept, replacing the earlier National Agriculture Insurance Scheme and Modified National Agricultural Insurance Scheme.

Q12. Who among the following was a famous Indian choreographer?

- (a) Kajol
- (b) Saroj Khan**
- (c) Shreya Ghoshal
- (d) Madhuri Dixit

Solution: 7.(b) Saroj Khan was a famous Choreographer. National Awards → 2007 → Best Choreography → Jab We Met. 2005 (Sringaram), 2002 (Devdas).

Q13. Uday Shankar was an Indian dancer best known for creati ng a_____.

- (a) Indian style of dance

(b) Fusion style of dance

- (c) Folk dance style
(d) American Style of dance

Solution: 13 . (b) Fusion style of dance . Uday Shankar - He came up with his own style of dance called 'Hi-dance', which he later rechristened it 'Creative dance'. Indian classical dance forms are : Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathak (Northern India), Kathakali (Kerala), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Manipuri (Manipur), Mohiniyattam (Kerala), Odissi (Odisha), Sattriya (Assam).

Q14. Identify the musician who is associated with the musical instrument Sarod.

- (a) Vilayat Khan
(b) Hariprasad Chaurasia
(c) Annapurna Devi
(d) Allaudin Khan

Solution: 13 .(d) Allaudin Khan. Awards - Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1952), Padma Bhushan (1958), Padma Vibhushan (1971). Proponents of Sarod - Ali Akbar Khan, Amjad Ali Khan, Buddhadev Das Gupta, Tejendra Majumdar. Flute - Hari Prasad Chaurasia, Pannalal Ghosh, Palladam Sanjiva Rao. Sitar - Pandit Ravi Shankar, Shahid Parvez Khan, Budhaditya Mukherjee, Anushka Shankar, Annapurna Devi, Vilayat Khan.

Q15. Who is famously known as Bihar Kesari?

- (a) Rajendra Prasad
(b) Shri Krishna Sinha
(c) Karpuri Thakur
(d) Lala Lajpat Rai

Solution: 2. (b) Shri Krishna Sinha was also known as Bihar Kesari and Shri Babu. He served as the first Chief Minister of Bihar from 1946 to 1961. Nicknames of other personalities - Rajendra Prasad (Desh Ratna, Ajatshatru), Karpuri Thakur (Jana Nayak) , Lala Lajpat Rai (Punjab Kesari).

Q16. Tanjore Balasaraswati was known for which classical dance form?

- (a) Bihu
(b) Bharatanatyam
(c) Manipuri
(d) Odissi

Solution: 14 .(b) Tanjore Balasaraswati → Bharatanatyam. In 1981 she was awarded the Sangeetha Kala Shikhamani award of The Indian Fine Arts Society, Chennai. Padmabhushan (1957), Padma Vibhushan (1977).

Q17. Who among the following Indian musicians is known as 'Pancham Da'?

- (a) Sachin Dev Barman
(b) Kishore Kumar
(c) Nitin Mukesh
(d) Rahul Dev Barman

Solution: 6 .(d) Rahul Dev Barman . He composed musical scores for 331 films. Awards : Filmfare for Best Music Director for Sanam Teri Kasam (1983). Other musicians and their nicknames : Lata Mangeshkar - "Queen of melody". Kishore Kumar - Kishore Da, AR Rahman - The Mozart of Madras. Usha Uthup - The Queen of Indipop.

Q18. Whom among the following players is associated with Javelin throw?

- (a) Neeraj Chopra**
(b) Pankaj Advani
(c) Saurabh Chaudhary
(d) Manika Batra

Solution: 2.(a) Neeraj Chopra. Awards: Padma Shri (2022), Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award (2021). Gold medal - Tokyo Olympic (2020), Commonwealth Games (2018), Asian Games (2018) . Pankaj Advani (Billiards and Snooker player): Award - Padma Bhushan (2018), Padma Shri (2009). Saurabh C Chaudhary (shooter) - He won the gold medal at the 2018 Asian Games. Manika Batra (table tennis): Arjuna Award (2018).

Q19. Banganga festival takes place annually at which of the following places in Maharashtra ?

- (a) Pune
(b) Nashik
(c) Mumbai
(d) Nagpur

Solution: 12 .(c) Mumbai . Banganga festival : A two-day music festival (tribute to Lord Rama) celebrated annually in the month of January in Malabar Hills, Mumbai. Conducted jointly by - MTDC (Maharashtra Tourism Development

Corporation) and Indian Heritage Society Mumbai. Banganga tank - A holy tank located in the complex of Wal keshwar temple in Malabar hills. Famous festivals of Maharashtra : Ganesh Chaturthi, Gudi Padwa, Chaitra Gauri, Ram Navami, Kojagiri Purnima, Khandoba Festival, Ellora Festival.

Q20. When was the Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award renamed as the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award?

- (a) 6th August 2022
(b) 5th January 2022
(c) 6th August 2021
(d) 5th January 2021

Solution: 1.(c) 6th August 2021. The Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award, established in 1992, is presented annually by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, Government of India, to recognize exceptional achievements by Indian athletes globally. The award consists of a medal, certificate, and a cash prize of ₹25 lakh. National Sports Day is observed every year on August 29th to commemorate the birth anniversary of Major Dhyan Chand, a legendary hockey player.

Q21. Which of the following states are a part of Garib Kalyan Rojgar Abhiyaan?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh and Gujarat
(b) Bihar and Madhya Pradesh
(c) Haryana and Bihar
(d) Assam and West Bengal

Solution: 3 .(b) Bihar and Madhya Pradesh. Garib Kalyan Rojgar Abhiyaan: Launched - 20 June 2020 (by Prime Minister Narendra Modi). Started - Khagaria district of Bihar. Aim - It will help in creating modern facilities in the rural areas. It will run for 125 days in 116 districts across six states - Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Jharkhand, Odisha and Rajasthan. 50000 crore rupees will be spent on this mega campaign. Under the scheme, the government will provide these migrant labourers with 25 work options.

Q22. The first Paralympic games were held in which year?

- (a) 1962
(b) 1960
(c) 1964
(d) 1961

Solution: 4.(b) 1960 . The first Paralympic Games - Rome (Italy). First winter Paralympics Games - Sweden (1976). First Olympic Games - Athens (1896). The first Winter Olympics - Chamonix (French), 1924. Venue of Olympic Games: 2024 - Paris, 2028 - Los Angeles. International Olympic Committee: Headquarters - Lausanne (Switzerland), Foundation - 23 June 1894.

Q23. Which of the following pairs of "players in a team-sports " is correct?

I. 11 - basketball II. 11 volleyball

- (a) Both I and II
(b) Neither I nor II
(c) Only I
(d) Only II

Solution: 14 (b) Neither I nor II. Number of Players - Baseball - 9, Basketball - 5 players on the court (total 12 players), Billiards/Snooker - 1, Boxing - 1, Chess - 1, Cricket - 11, Croquet - 3 or 6, Football (Soccer) - 11, Hockey - 11, Kabaddi - 7, Volleyball - 6, Kho Kho - 9, Lacrosse - 10, Netball - 7, Polo - 4, Rugby - 15, Water Polo - 7.

Q24. Kajari Mahotsav is primarily celebrated in which of the following districts of Uttar Pradesh?

- (a) Mirzapur**
(b) Gorakhpur
(c) Kushi Nagar
(d) Jhansi

Solution: 3.(a) Mirzapur. The festival is celebrated in honor of King Kantil Naresh's daughter, Kajali, renowned for her melodious love songs. Other major festivals in Uttar Pradesh include Ganga Mahotsav in Varanasi and Taj Mahotsav in Agra.

Q25. Raja Bhalindra Singh trophy is associated with which of the following national sports events?

- (a) Khelo India Youth Games
(b) Khelo India Winter Games
(c) Khelo India University Games
(d) National Games

Solution: 14.(d) National Games. The National Games are organized by the

Indian Olympic Association (IOA). The IOA is responsible for the regulations of the games. IOA: Founded - 1927, Headquarter - New Delhi. First National Games organised in Lahore (1924). First Modern National Games - New Delhi (1985). 37th National Games - Goa (October 2023).

Q26. 'Penalty Corner' is related to which of the following sports?

- (a) Chess
- (b) Tennis
- (c) Badminton
- (d) Hockey**

Solution: 6.(d) Hockey . Terms related to Hockey - Cross, Dangerous Play, Defense (Defender), Drive, Flagrant Foul, Flick, Goal-line, Long Hit, Penalty Stroke, Raised Ball, Scoop, Striker, Tackle, Undercutting . Chess - Grandmaster, Back-rank, checkmate. Tennis - Alley, Backhand, Double Fault, Lob, Stanc e, Topspin. Badminton - Hairpin Net Shot, Rally, Flick.

Q27. How many players are th ere in a Field Hockey team?

- (a) 7
- (b) 11**
- (c) 15
- (d) 19

Solution: 8.(b) Field Hockey team consists of Eleven Players in each team. The pitch on which field hockey is played is 91.4m long and 55m wide.

Q28. Pt Hariprasad Chaurasia is a well-known:

- (a) tabla -player
- (b) sitarist
- (c) vocalist
- (d) flutalist**

Solution: 1.(d) Famous Flutalist in India → Hariprasad Chaurasia , Devendra Murdeshwar , Mayavaram Saraswathi Ammal , K. Bhaskaran , Sikkil Mala Chandrasekar, Debopriya Chatterjee, Rakesh Chaurasia . Milind Date.

Q29. Which of the given personalities is NOT associated with Carnatic Music?

- (a) Kalyani Varadarajan
- (b) MS Subbulakshmi
- (c) Vishnu Narayan Bhatkhande**
- (d) Subramania Bharathiyar

Solution: 8.(c) Vishnu Narayan Bhatkhande - He was related to Hindustani classical music. Other personalities related to Carnatic music - Purandaradasa (Father of Carnatic music), Kanaka Dasa, Muthu Thandavar, Tyagaraja, Muthuswami Dikshitar, Syama Sastri, Arun a Sairam, Semmangudi Srinivasa Iyer, Lalgudi Jayaraman.

Q30. Warli Painting is the folk painting of _____ state of India.

- (a) Manipur
- (b) Mizoram
- (c) Karnataka
- (d) Maharashtra**

Solution: 1. (d) Maharashtra . Warli painting is a form of tribal art mostly created by the tribal people from the North Sahyadri Range in Maharashtra. Other folk paintings - Bihar (Madhubani Paintings), Odisha (Pattachitra Art), Gujarat (Pith ora Painting), Andhra Pradesh (Kalamkari Paintings), West Bengal (Kalighat Pat Art), Miniature Painting (Rajasthan), Tanjore Painting (Tamil Nadu), Gond Painting (Madhya Pradesh), Phad (Rajasthan), Cherialy Scrolls (Telangana).

Q31. Who is the first trans woman to win a Padma Shri award for Bharatanatyam?

- (a) Bishesh Huirem
- (b) Narthaki Nataraj**
- (c) Sruthy Sithara
- (d) Sadhana Mishra

Solution: 9.(b) Narthaki Nataraj is the first trans woman to win a Padma Shri Award for Bharatnatyam . Kalaimamani Award of Tamil Nadu Government in 2007, Nritya Choodamani Award from Krishna Gana Sabha in 2009,Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 2011, Vetri Award from University of Madras in 2013 Honorary Doctorate from Periyar Maniammai University 2016, ICCR E mpanelled Dance Artist in Outstanding Category 2017.

Q32. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana was introduced in 2015 under the _____.

- (a) Ministry of Rural development
- (b) Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs
- (c) Ministry of Finance

(d) Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship

Solution: 6.(d) Pradhan Mantri Kausal Vikas Yojana was introduced in 2015 under the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship. 15th July is celebrated as World Youth Skills Day.

Q33. Where were the 35th National Games held in the year 2015 ?

- (a) Delhi
- (b) Mumbai
- (c) Punjab
- (d) Kerala**

Solution: 7 . (d) Kerala. National Games:- Kerala hosted this second time (first time hosted 27th National Games in1987). 35th National Games: Opening ceremony held at Greenfield Stadium inaugurated by Shri Venkaiah Naidu. First National Games organised in Lahore (1924). First Modern National Games - New Delhi (1985). They were hosted in various Places, including Bombay and Pune (1994), Bangalore and Mysore (1997), Imphal (1999), Punjab (2001), Andhra Pradesh (2002), Guwahati (2007), Jharkhand (2011), and Gujarat (2022). 37th National Games - Goa (October 2023).

Q34. Who was the first Indian woman wrestler to represent the country at the 2012 London Olympic Games?

- (a) Babita Phogat
- (b) Sakshi Malik
- (c) Vinesh Phogat
- (d) Geeta Phogat**

Solution: 11.(d) Geeta Phogat. She is a freestyle wrestler who won India's first-ever gold medal in wrestling in the 55kg freestyle category at the 2010 Commonwealth Games for India. Her Award: Arjuna Award (2012).

Q35. Which of the following sitar players was awarded the Bharat Ratna in the year 1999?

- (a) Pandit Bhimsen Joshi
- (b) Pandit Ravishankar**
- (c) Hariprasad Ch ourasia
- (d) Bhupen Hazarika

Solution: 3.(b) Pandit Ravishankar (sitar player). Awards: Padma Vibhushan (1981) ,Padma Bhushan (1967), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1962), Kalidas Samman (1987-1988). Pandit Bhimsen Joshi (Indian vocalist): Award - Bharat Ratna (2009), Padma Vibhushan (1999). Hariprasad Chourasia (flute player): Award - Padma Vibhushan (2000), Padma Bhushan (1992). Bhupen Hazarika (singer): Award - Bharat Ratna (2019) (posthumously), Padma Vibhushan (2012) (posthumously).

Q36. In which state is the Maski inscription located at present?

- (a) Tamil Nadu
- (b) Andhra Pradesh
- (c) Madhya Pradesh
- (d) Karnataka**

Solution: 14 .(d) Karnataka . Maski inscription : Ashoka's minor rock edict. It is situated on the banks of the Muski River, a tributary of the Tungabhadra River. The inscription is written in the Brahmi s cript. The edict was the first of Emperor Ashoka to include the name Ashoka and not by his usual Title 'Devanampiya Piyadasa'. Discovered by - C. Beadon in 1915.

Q37. Who among the following is the author of the book 'The Bud dha and his Dhamma', which appeared in 1957 after the death of its author?

- (a) Subhas Chandra Bose
- (b) BR Ambedkar**
- (c) Mahatma Gandhi
- (d) Motilal Nehru

Solution: 10 .(b) BR Ambedkar. Other Books - "Castes in India" (1916), "The Problem of the Rupee" (1923), "Bahishkrit Bharat" (1927), "The Annihilation of Caste" (1936), "Federation Versus Freedom" (1939), "Thoughts on Pakistan" (1940), "Ranade, Gandhi and Jinnah" (1943), "Mr. Gandhi and Emancipa tion of Untouchables" (1943), "Pakistan Or Partition Of India" (1945), "Who were the Shudras" (1948), "The Untouchables" (1948), "Buddha Or Karl Marx" (1956).

Q38. The colours of the squares used in a chessboard are _____.

- (a) white and black**
- (b) red and black
- (c) white and green

(d) white and red

Solution: 15 .(a) White and Black. FIDE (International Chess Federation), the governing body of the sport of chess, and it regulates all international chess competitions. Headquarter - Lausanne (Switzerland). Establishment - 1924. Minimum FIDE rating required to earn the "Grandmaster" (GM) title - 2500. First Indian Chess GrandMaster - Viswanathan Anand. Famous Players - Gukesh D, Magnus Carlsen, Mitrabha Guha, Vuppala Praneeth, Aditya Mittal, Koneru Humpy.

Q39. Bimbavati Devi is an exponent of which Indian dance form?

- (a) Chhau
- (b) Manipuri
- (c) Kathakali
- (d) Odissi

Solution: 4.(b) Bimbavati Devi is the exponent of Manipuri dance form. Some of other Manipuri dancers: Guru Bipin Singh, Rajkumar Singhjit Singh, Charu Sija Mathur. Kathakali (Kerala): Kalamandalam Ramankutty Nair, Kalamandalam Gopi, Madavoor Vasudevan Nair, Milena Salvini. Odissi (Odisha): Kelucharan Mohapatra, Sonal Mansingh. Chhau (Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West-Bengal).

Q40. Padma Shri and Padma Bhushan awardee, Yamini Krishnamurthy is renowned for Bharatanatyam and which of the following dances?

- (a) Kathak
- (b) Manipuri
- (c) Kuchipudi
- (d) Kathakali

Solution: 9.(c) Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh) . Awards of Yamini Krishnamurthy - Padma Shri (1968), Padma Bhushan (2001), Padma Vibhushan (2016), Natya Shashtra Award (2014). Other Dancers of Kuchipudi - Radha Reddy And Raja Reddy, Yamini Reddy, Kaushalya Reddy, Bhavana Reddy, Lakshmi Narayn Shastri, Indrani Rehman. Manipuri Dancers - Yumlembam Gambhini Devi, Nirmala Mehta, Guru Bipin Singh, Jhaveri Sisters.

Q41. A football match lasts two equal periods of _____.

- (a) 40 minutes
- (b) 50 minutes
- (c) 20 minutes
- (d) 45 minutes

Solution: 1 .(d) 45 minutes. A football team consists of 11 players on the field, including 1 goalkeeper and 10 position players. Football Terminology: Back heel, cross, far post, futsal, Header, Inswinger. Games and their duration : Hockey (two periods of 35 minutes), Basketball (48 minutes or 12 minutes each quarter), Kabaddi (two halves of 20 minutes).

Q42. Which of the following Indian classical dance forms uses various colours on face to symbolise the characters?

- (a) Odissi
- (b) Kathakali
- (c) Bharatanatyam
- (d) Mohiniattam

Solution: 12.(b) Kathakali is famous for its intricate choreography and elaborate makeup and costumes. The makeup and costumes inform the viewer of the type of character on stage, as there is no dialogue throughout the performance. This dance originates primarily from the Indian state of Kerala . The characters in a Kathakali performance are broadly divided into Satvika, Rajasika and T amasika .

Q43. In which district of Gujarat is the Modhera dance festival organized by the Government of Gujarat?

- (a) Amreli
- (b) Bharuch
- (c) Dang
- (d) Mehsana

Solution: 12 .(d) Mehsana. The Sun Temple of Modhera is a masterpiece of the Solanki Empire, which hosts the annual Modhera Dance Festival. States and their festivals : Gujarat - Navratri, Janmashtami, Rann Utsav, Uttarayana, Shamlaji Mela, Vautha Mela, Bhadra Purnima; Maharashtra - Ganesh Chathurthi, Gudi Padva, Bhau Beej, Ellora Festival, Ashadhi Ekadashi, Mangala Gauri, Pola, Kojagiri Purnima, Banganga.

Q44. Annapurna Devi is associated with which of the following musical instruments?

- (a) Rudra Veena
- (b) Taal

(c) Ektara

(d) Surbahar

Solution: 5.(d) Surbahar. The surbahar, often called the bass sitar, is a stringed instrument used in Hindustani classical music with a lower pitch than the sitar. Annapurna Devi, a notable musician of the Maihar gharana, was honored with the Padma Bhushan in 1977, Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 1991. Other Surbahar Exponents - Ustad Imrat Khan, Buddhaditya Mukherjee, Pushparaj Koshti, Kushal Das.

Q45. Ricky Kej won his third Grammy under which of the following categories?

- (a) Song of the Year
- (b) Best Contemporary Instrumental Album
- (c) Best Immersive Audio Album
- (d) Album of the Year

Solution: 2 .(c) Best Immersive Audio Album (Divine Tides). The 65 th Grammy Awards (music industry) 2023 were held at the Crypto.com arena in Los Angeles (South California). Category and winner: Album of the Year - (Harry Styles- Harry's House), Song of the Year - (Lizzo-About Damn time), Best Traditional Pop Vocal Album - (Michael Buble-Higher), Best Country Song - 'Til You Can't' (Cody Johnson).

Q46. Which Indian musician from Maharashtra received the Padma Vibhushan 2023 ?

- (a) Ramdas Palsule
- (b) Bharat Kamat
- (c) Zakir Hussain
- (d) Milind Date

Solution: 13.(c) Zakir Hussain (tabla player). Awards - Padma Shri (1988), Padma Bhushan (2002), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1991), Kalidas Samman (2006). Other Maestro Of Tabla: Pandit Ramdas Palsule, Bharat Kamat, AllaRakha Khan. Flautist - Milind Date, Hariprasad Chaurasi, Pandit Ronu Majumdar.

Q47. Merchants and migrants first brought the teachings of the holy Quran to India in the _____century.

- (a) fourth
- (b) seventh
- (c) ninth
- (d) sixth

Solution: 13.(b) Merchants and migrants first brought the teachings of the holy Quran to India in the seventh century. Different religions and their holy books : Islam (Quran and Sunnah), Sikhism (Guru Granth Sahib), Jainism (Jain Agamas), Buddhist (Tipitaka), Hinduism (Bhagwat Gita, Ved, Upnishad), Christianity (Bible), Rastafari (Bible, Kebra Nagast, The Promise Key, Holy Piby), Shinto (Kojiki, Nihon Shoki, Fudoki), Zoroastrianism (Zend Avesta), etc.

Q48. Asad Ali Khan is best known for his mastery over which of the given musical instruments?

- (a) Surbahar
- (b) Violin
- (c) Tabla
- (d) Rudra Veena

Solution: 15 .(d) Rudra Veena. Asad Ali Khan : He was an Indian musician who played this stringed instrument. Khan performed in the Dhrupad style and was described by The Hindu as the best living Rudra Veena player in India. Awards : Padma Bhushan (2008). Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for Hindustani Musi c (1977).

Q49. Who among the following is/was a famous sitarist?

- (a) Ravi Shankar
- (b) Ustad Bismillah Khan
- (c) Pandit Bhimsen Joshi
- (d) Zakir Hussain

Solution: 8.(a) Ravi Shankar. He was an Indian musician and founder of the National Orchestra of India, who was influential in stimulating Western appreciation of Indian music. His Awards: Bharat Ratna (1999), Padma Vibhushan (1981), Padma Bhushan (1967), and Grammy Award (1968) for Best Chamber Music Performance for his work "West Meets East."

Q50. Dr N Rajam is known for playing the _____.

- (a) veena
- (b) guitar
- (c) violin

(d) flute

Solution: 13.(c) Popular Violinist in India → Dr. N Rajam , Abhijith P. S. Nair, B. Sasikumar, Harikumar Sivan, Embar Kannan, Kala Ramnath, Sunita Bhuyan , Akkarai Subbalakshmi , Vittal Ramamurthy, Ragini Shankar, Manoj George, Gagan Chandra Chatterjee, Sangeeta Shanka etc

Q51. Select the correct statement about the achievements of Sruti Bandyopadhyay, an eminent Manipuri dancer.

- (a) She received Padma Shri for the year 2020.
- (b) She received the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for the year 2020.**
- (c) She received Kalidas Samman for the year 2020.
- (d) She received Padma Vibhushan for the year 2020.

Solution: 7.(b) Other Dance forms and their dancers : Manipuri - Nayana, Suverna, Ranjana, and Darshana, Guru Bipin Singh. Odissi - Guru Pankaj Charan Das, Sonal Mansingh, Kelucharan Mohapatra, Geeta Mahalik, Dr. Minati Mishra, Madhavi Mudgal. Sattriya - Ghanakanta Bora, Jatin Goswami, Srimanta Sankardev.

Q52. The renowned ghazal singer Girija Devi was born in _____.

- (a) Karnataka
- (b) Bihar
- (c) Uttar Pradesh**
- (d) Punjab

Solution: 15.(c) Uttar Pradesh. Girija Devi was a Thumri singer of the Senia and Banaras gharanas. She was dubbed as the 'Queen of Thumri' for her contribution in the genre. Awards : Padma Shri (1972), Padma Bhushan (1989), Padma Vibhushan (2016), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1977), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (2010).

Q53. International Tiger Day is observed on _____

- (a) July 5th
- (b) July 30th
- (c) July 29th**
- (d) July 4th

Solution: 10 (c) 29 July 29th - Celebrate with the aim of conserving tigers and saving their endangered species. International Tiger Day was founded in 2010 at Saint Petersburg Tiger Summit in Russia, where governments of tiger-populated countries vowed to double tiger population by 2022. The Tiger Estimation Report 2022 , a data released by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, states that the tiger population in India has increased from 2,226 (in the year 2014) to 3,167 (in the year 2022).

Q54. Which of the following is NOT a polar animal?

- (a) Ringed seals
- (b) Musk oxen
- (c) Lemur**
- (d) Walrus

Solution: 3.(c) Lemurs are a type of prosimian, which means they are primates that evolved before monkeys and apes. Polar Animals Polar Bear, Arctic Fox, Antarctic Minke Whale, Brown Bear, Pacific Salmon, Orca , Snowy Owl, Leopard Seal, Arctic Wolf, Penguin, Walrus, Narwhal , Arctic Hare, Beluga Whale, Puffin, Reindeer, Musk Oxen.

Q55. Who was given the title of 'Hanjaba' by the Maharaj of Manipur for reviving Manipuri dance?

- (a) Charu Malhar
- (b) Darshana Jhaveri
- (c) Bipin Singh**
- (d) Kalavati Devi

Solution: 4 .(c) Bipin Singh. He is regarded as the father of modern Manipuri dance and style belonging to the Bishnupriya Manipuri community. Awards: Sangeet Natak Akademi (1966), Kalidas Samman (1989-90). Famous Manipuri Dancers : Darshana Jhaveri, Yumlembam Gambhini Devi, Nirmala Mehta, Charu Mathur, Nayana, Devyani Chalia, Darshana Jhaveri, Kalavati Devi.

Q56. Krishnadeva Raya composed a work on _____ in Telugu known as the Amuktamalyada.

- (a) statecraft**
- (b) dance
- (c) medicine
- (d) music

Solution: 14 .(a) Statecraft. Krishnadevaraya : Ruler of the Tuluva dynasty of Vijayanagar empire (1509-29 AD). He also founded a suburban township near Vijayanagar called Nagalapuram. Vijayanagara Empire (City of victory) :

Founded in 1336 AD by Harihara and Bukka of the Sangama dynasty. Capital - Hampi (along the river Tungabhadra). Vijayanagar Empire was ruled by Sangama, Saluva, Tuluva, Aravidu Dynasties.

Q57. Thomas Cup is a/an _____ .

- (a) annual event
- (b) biennial event**
- (c) quarterly event
- (d) triennial event

Solution: 5.(b) Biennial event. Thomas Cup - The first tournament was held in 1948 - 49 and won by Malaya. India's men's badminton team won the Thomas Cup title for the first time ever in 2022 by defeating Indonesia. Uber Cup - First held in 1956–1957 and contested at three year intervals, it has been contested every two years since 1984.

Q58. The Kuchipudi classical dance is accompanied with which type of music?

- (a) Kajri
- (b) Chaiti
- (c) Carnatic Music**
- (d) Hindustani Music

Solution: 5.(c) Kuchipudi dance is accompanied with Carnatic music, while the recital is in Telugu language. Bharatanatyam , Kathakali , and Mohiniattam , are accompanied by the classical southern Indian Carnatic music. Manipuri : Devotional music, Odisha : Odissi Music, Sattriya : Borgeet music, Kathak : Hindustani Music. Kajri and Chaiti Dance (Uttar pradesh).

Q59. Who among the following is known as a pioneering dance educationist and a prominent Mohiniyattam exponent?

- (a) Madhavi Mudgal
- (b) Shagun Butani
- (c) Mohanrao Kallianpurkar
- (d) Dr Kanak Rele**

Solution: 11.(d) Dr. Kanak Rele . She is the founder-director of the Nalanda Dance Research Centre (1967) and the founder-principal of the Nalanda Nritya Kala Mahavidyalaya in Mumbai. Awards and Honors : Gaurav Puraskar (Gujarat ; 1989), Padma Shri (1990), Kala Vipanchi (Vipanchi institution ; 2005), Kalidas Samman (Madhya Pradesh, 2006), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1994), Padma Bhushan (2013). Madhavi Mudgal (Odissi dancer), Shagun Bhutan (Odissi Dancer), Mohanrao Kallianpurka (Kathak dancer).

Q60. Which Indian freedom fighter is also known as Bismarck of India?

- (a) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel**
- (b) Mahatma Gandhi
- (c) Lal Bahadur Shastri
- (d) Jawaharlal Nehru

Solution: 12 .(a) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel (Full name - Vallabhbhai Jhaverbhai Patel). Other names of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel - Sardar Patel, Iron Man Of India. Mahatma Gandhi (Full name - Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi) - Bapu (This name given by Shubhash Chandra Bose), Mahatma (This name given by Rabindranath Tagore), Malang Baba (This name given by Kabailis of North-West Frontier), Half-naked fakir (This name was given by Winston Churchill). Lal bahadur Shastri - Man of Peace, Jawaharlal Nehru - Chacha, Panditji.

Q61. The word Manuscripts derived from which of the following language?

- (a) Latin**
- (b) Prakrit
- (c) Sanskrit
- (d) Greek

Solution: 2.(a) The manuscript word evolved from the Latin Manu S criptus , meaning "written by hand." Manu is "hand" and S criptus is "to write." These were written on palm leaves and on the bark of birch trees. Palaeography is the study of pre-modern manuscripts: hand-written books, rolls, scrolls and single-sheet documents.

Q62. What is the average circumference of the standard cricket ball in international cricket?

- (a) 7.89 inches - 8.45 inches
- (b) 10.46 inches - 10.90 inches
- (c) 9.45 inches - 10.20 inches
- (d) 8.81 inches-9 inches**

Solution: 7.(d) The standard cricket ball in international cricket has an average circumference of 8.81inches - 9 inches . Cricket pitch breadth : 10 feet . Important terminologies used in Cricket: Striker, Off-side/leg-side, Run, Four,

Bowled, Caught, LBW, Stumped, Innings, etc.

Q63. Which of the following personalities is a famous Bharatanatyam dancer?

- (a) Birju Maharaj
- (b) Padma Subrahmanyam**
- (c) Naik Siddiqui
- (d) Saswati Sen

Solution: 10 .(b) Padma Subrahmanyam. Awards - Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1983), Padma Shri (1981), Padma Bhushan (2003). Other Bharatanatyam dancers - Rukmini Devi Arundale, Alarmel Valli, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Mallika Sarabhai, T. Bala Saraswati, Shobhana Pillai, Sonal Mansingh, Shudha Chandran, Vyjayantimala, Mrinalini Sarabhai. Kathak dancers - Birju Maharaj, Shovana Narayan, Nahid Siddiqui, Saswati Sen, Lachhu Maharaj, Shambhu Maharaj, Uday Shankar, Sitara devi.

Q64. To which state of India is the Hornbill festival related?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Nagaland**
- (d) Bihar

Solution: 12.(c) Nagaland's Festival → Hornbill Festival, Aoleng Festival, Sekrenyi Festival, Moatsii Mong , Mim Kut Festival, Bushu Dima.

Q65. Who was the first Indian Army officer to be promoted to the rank of field marshal?

- (a) Vikram Batra
- (b) Karam Singh
- (c) Sam Manekshaw**
- (d) KM Cariappa

Solution: 8.(c) Sam Manekshaw : Chief of the Army Staff of the Indian Army during the Indo-Pakistani War of 1971. Field Marshal is a five-star general officer rank and the highest attainable rank in the Indian Army . Karam Singh : recipient of the Param Vir Chakra(1950). KM Cariappa : First Indian Commander-in-Chief of the Indian Army. Vikram Batra : Martyr of Kargil war, Param Vir Chakra (1999).

Q66. Kye Gompa, the largest centre of Buddhist learning in the Western Himalayas, is situated in the state/union territory of _____.

- (a) Uttarakhand
- (b) Himachal Pradesh**
- (c) Punjab
- (d) Jammu & Kashmir

Solution: 15 .(b) Himachal Pradesh. Famous Buddhist monasteries: Hemis Monastery - Ladakh, Tabo Monastery - Himachal Pradesh, Tsuglagkhang Monastery - Himachal Pradesh, Thiksey Monastery - Leh, Ladakh, Tawang Monastery - Arunachal Pradesh, Bylakuppe Monastery (Namdroling) - Karnataka , Ghoom Monastery - West Bengal, Lingdum Monastery - Sikkim.

Q67. Which of the following states was the overall champion in both men and women categories in the first Janjatiya Khel Mahotsav?

- (a) Maharashtra
- (b) Chhattisgarh
- (c) Jharkhand
- (d) Odisha**

Solution: 10.(d) Odisha. The first Janjatiya Khel Mahotsav, a grand sporting event jointly hosted by the Ministry of Culture, the Odisha Government, and KIIT University, concluded in Bhubaneswar. The first edition attracted the participation of 5,000 tribal athletes and 1,000 officials from 26 states.

Q68. According to census 2011, the male literacy rate in India is _____

- (a) 81.14 percent
- (b) 82.14 percent**
- (c) 84.14 percent
- (d) 83.14 percent

Solution: 10.(b) According to census 2011, the male literacy rate in India is 82.14 % . Female literacy rate: 65.46% . literacy rate of India: 74.04% . Highest literacy rate: Kerala (94.0%) {male literacy rate is 96.11% and the female literacy rate is 92.07%}. Lowest literacy rate : Bihar (61.8%).

Q69. Which of the following dances is performed by the Santhal tribe of Jharkhand?

- (a) Jhika Dasain**

- (b) Kolkali
- (c) Ghumar
- (d) Koli

Solution: 9.(a) Jhika Dashain . It is performed a few days before Dussehra. States and their Folk dances - Jharkhand : Alkap, Karm a Munda, Agni, Jhumar, Janani Jhumar, Mardana Jhumar, Paika, Phagua. Bihar : Jata-Jatin, Bakho-Bakhain, Panwariya. Chhattisgarh : Gaur Maria, Panthi, Raut Nacha, Pandwani.

Q70. Assam and most of the Peninsular states have _____ population densities.

- (a) high to very high
- (b) very low
- (c) moderate**
- (d) moderate to high

Solution: 10.(c) Assam and most of the Peninsular states have moderate population densities. The Population density in Assam is 398 persons.

Q71. Kuchipudi is a classical dance form of which Indian state?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Tamil Nadu
- (d) Andhra Pradesh**

Solution: 4.(d) Kuchipudi → Andhra Pradesh, Bharatnatyam → Tamil Nadu. Kathakali, Moniyattam → Kerala, Yakshagana → Karnataka.

Q72. Carnatic music is confined to _____.

- (a) Karnataka, Maharashtra, Gujarat and Rajasthan
- (b) Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, West Bengal and Haryana
- (c) Gujarat, Maharashtra, Rajasthan and Haryana
- (d) Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu and Kerala**

Solution: 3. (d) Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu and Kerala. Purandaradasa is considered to be the father of Carnatic music. It is accompanied by instruments such as the flute, veena, nadaswaram, mridangam and ghatam.

Q73. Padayani', a local dance form primarily performed in _____ to please Goddess Bhadrakali.

- (a) Assam
- (b) Kerala**
- (c) Odisha
- (d) West Bengal

Solution: 12.(b) Kerala. Padayani literally means "row of warriors" is a dance. It is regarded as a remnant of the Dravidian forms of worship that existed before the advent of Brahmanism. The percussion instruments used are padayani thappu, chenda, para and kumbham. Other dances of Kerala : Mudi yettu, Thiruvathirakali, Kolkali, Oppana, Kummattikali, Chavittu Natakam.

Q74. Nag Panchami is celebrated in which month of Hindu Calendar ?

- (a) Shravan**
- (b) Kartik
- (c) Sharad
- (d) Asadh

Solution: 11 .(a) Shravan . Other festivals in Shravan month - Raksha Bandhan, Hariyali Teej, Narali Purnima. Kartik Month festival - Karwa Chauth, Rama Ekadashi, Dhanteras, Lakshmi Puja (Deewali), Bhaiya Dooj, Chhath Puja. Ashad - Jagannath Rathayatra, Guru Purnima, Yogini Ekadashi. Sharad Purnima is the harvest festival that is celebrated during the holy month of Ashwin in the Hindu lunar calendar.

Q75. Where did Vivek ananda participate at the World's Parliament of Religions?

- (a) San Francisco
- (b) New York
- (c) Washington
- (d) Chicago**

Solution: 11 .(d) Chicago (1893). Narendranath Datta (Maharaja Ajit Singh of the Khetri gave him the name 'Vivekananda') - He introduced the world to the Indian philosophies of Vedanta and Yoga. Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose had called Vivekananda "Maker of modern India". He established the Ramakrishna Mission and Belur Math in West Bengal. Books - Raja-yoga, Karma-yoga, Jnana-yoga and Bhakti-yoga.

Q76. Which of the following festivals is known as Vijaya Utsav?

(a) Hampi Festival

- (b) Gangasagar Mela
- (c) Pushkar Fair
- (d) Konark Dance Festival

Solution: 8.(a) Hampi festival (Karnataka), also known as Vijay Utsav, is celebrated for 2 or 3 days and reflects the pomp, splendor and glory of the Vijayanagara Empire. Other Festivals of Karnataka : Kambala, Ugadi, Pattadakal Dance festival, Vairamundi, Karaga, Vara Mahalakshmi pooja, ganesh Chaturthi, Gowri. Pushkar Fair : Rajasthan . Konark Dance festival: Odisha . Gangasagar Mela : West Bengal.

Q77. Where was the first women's international test cricket match hosted in India in 1976?

- (a) New Delhi
- (b) Bangalore**
- (c) Mumbai
- (d) Kolkata

Solution: 2.(b) Bangalore. India hosted its first women's international Test cricket match against the West Indies on October 31, 1976, at M. Chinnaswamy Stadium in Bangalore. The Six-test series ended in a 1–1 draw. India secured its first Test victory in the fourth match in Patna on November 19, led by Shantha Rangaswamy, the first women's cricket captain of India. The inaugural Women's Cricket World Cup was held in England in 1973.

Q78. Freedom in Exile is the autobiography of _____.

- (a) Nelson Mandela
- (b) APJ Abdul Kalam
- (c) Dalai Lama**
- (d) Mahatma Gandhi

Solution: 11.(c) 'Freedom in Exile' Dalai Lama, 'Long Walk to Freedom' Nelson Mandela, 'The Wings of Fire' APJ Abdul Kalam, 'The Story of My Experiments with Truth' Mahatma Gandhi.

Q79. Lingaraja Temple is situated in which of the following states of India?

- (a) Odisha**
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Maharashtra
- (d) Tamil Nadu

Solution: 7.(a) Odisha : Dedicated to Lord Shiva(Bhubaneswar). Karnataka : The Chalukya Shiva Temple (LadKhan Temple) in Aihole. Maharashtra : Ter Temple, is a temple of Vamana (an incarnation of Vishnu) , Trimbakeshwar Temple of Lord Shiva in Nashik. Tamil Nadu : Murugan Temple at Saluvankuppam, Brihadeeswarar Temple(Thanjavur).

Q80. Who is the author of 'Anna Karenina'?

- (a) Gabriel Garcia Marquez
- (b) EM Forster
- (c) George Eliot
- (d) Leo Tolstoy**

Solution: 5.(d) Books By Leo Tolstoy ' Anna K arenina' (1887) , 'War and Peace' (1869), 'The Kreutzer Sonata' (1889), 'The Death of Ivan Ilyich' (1886), 'Sevastopol Sketches' (1855), 'Resurrection' (1899), 'The Cossacks' (1863), 'A Confession' (1882), 'The Kingdom of God Is Within You' (1894), 'What I Believe' (1885).

Q81. In Table Tennis, how many lets are allowed in a row on a serve?

- (a) Three
- (b) Unlimited**
- (c) Two
- (d) One

Solution: 15.(b) There's no limit on the number of times one can replay when it has hit the net. Table tennis is played on a 2.74 x 1.53 metre rectangular table made of fiber wood and is split into two halves. The game was invented in England and was originally called Ping-Pong , a trademark name. International Table Tennis Federation (founded in 1926).

Q82. What is the full form of NCRB?

- (a) National Currency Records Branch
- (b) National Capital Register Bureau
- (c) National Criminal Records Bureau
- (d) National Crime Records Bureau**

Solution: 11 .(d) National Crime Records Bureau is an Indian government agency responsible for collecting and analyzing crime data as defined by the

Indian Penal Code (IPC) and Special and Local Laws (SLL). Headquarter - New Delhi . Ministry - Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA). Established - 1986. It implements Crime and Criminal Tracking Network System (CCTNS).

Q83. 'Unfinished: A Memoir' is the autobiography of _____.

- (a) Priyanka Chopra Jonas**
- (b) Deepika Padukone
- (c) Kareena Kapoor
- (d) Alia Bhatt

Solution: 15.(a) 'Unfinished: A Memoir' is the autobiography of Priyanka Chopra Jonas.

Q84. The Commonwealth Games 2018 were held at which of the following places?

- (a) Gold coast**
- (b) Edinburgh
- (c) Victoria
- (d) Kuala Lumpur

Solution: 1.(a) Commonwealth Games 2018 : Host (Gold Coast , Australia), Top Association (Australia). 2022: Host (Birmingham, England England), Top Association (Australia). 2026 : Host (State of Victoria, Australia).

Q85. Which of the following is the most important festival celebrated by the Muslim community in India to mark the beginning of the Islamic New Year?

- (a) Milad-Un-Nabi
- (b) Muharram**
- (c) Idu'l Zuha
- (d) Idul Fitr

Solution: 9.(b) Muharram (July). Muharram is the name of the first month of the Hijri calendar. In Islam there are 4 months (Zu al-Qada, Zu al-Hajja, Muharram and Rajab) which are considered the most sacred. Milad-un-Nabi (festival to commemorate the birth anniversary of Prophet Muhammad), Id ul Z uha (to commemorate the obedience, willingness, and devotion of Prophet Ibrahim towards his God), Eid al-Fitr (end of Ramadan, the Muslim holy month of fasting).

Q86. Who was the first Odissi dancer from Odisha to receive Padm a Vibhushan?

- (a) Sonal Mansingh
- (b) Sanjukta Panigrahi
- (c) Kelucharan Mohapatra**
- (d) Madhvi Mudgal

Solution: 13 .(c) Kelucharan Mohapatra. Awards : Padma Vibhushan (2000), Padma Bhushan (1988), Padma Shri (1974), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for Dance (1966). Sonal Mansingh (Odissi and Bharatanatyam Dancer) : Awards - (Youngest reci pient) Padma Vibhushan (2003), Padma Bhushan (1992). Sanjukta Panigrahi (foremost exponent of Odissi) : Awards - Padma Shri (1975). Madhvi Mudgal : Padma Shri (1990).

Q87. Matki dance is the famous folk dance associated with which of the following states?

- (a) Punjab
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Madhya Pradesh**
- (d) Maharashtra

Solution: 4.(c) Madhya Pradesh. The "Matki Dance," performed using a small pitcher, is particularly popular in the Malwa region of Madhya Pradesh. Other traditional dances of Madhya Pradesh include Jawara, Grida, Chaitra, Kaksar, Karma, Maanch, Tertali, Pardhoni, and Kanara.

Q88. Who is famously known as sitar maestro in India?

- (a) Maharshi Patanjali
- (b) Pt. Ravi Shankar**
- (c) Ustad Bismillah khan
- (d) Sitara Devi

Solution: 4.(b) Pandit Ravi Shankar . Awards - Bharat Ratna (1999), Padma Bhushan (1967), Padma Vibhushan (1981), Ramon Magsaysay Award (1992). Maharshi Patanjali - The Father of Yoga. Ustad Bismillah khan (Shehnai Vadak) Awards - Bharat Ratna (2001), Padma Shri (1961), Padma Bhushan (1968), Padma Vibhushan (1980). Sitara Devi - Classical Kathak Dancer.

Q89. Since which year did the IPL start?

- (a) 2010

- (b) 2007
- (c) 2008
- (d) 2009

Solution: 2.(c) Indian Premier League (IPL) was started in 2008. Gujarat Titans won IPL 2022 under the captaincy of Hardik Pandya. Mumbai Indians (MI) is the most successful IPL team, having won the IPL tournament five times.

- (a) 5
- (b) 10
- (c) 15
- (d) 20

Solution: 3.(b) The Hornbill Festival is an annual festival celebrated by Warrior Tribes of Nagaland from 1 to 10 of December (10 days) . Other festivals of Nagaland include Sekrenyi (Angami tribe), Tsukheneye (Chakhesang tribe), Aoleang (Konyak tribe), Naknyulem (Chang tribe), Mimkut (Kuki Tribe), Tokhu Emong (Lotha tribe), Tuluni (Sumi Tribe), etc.

Q90. For how many days is the Hornbill festival held?